

POLICY: Sabbatical Leave	POLICY DESCRIPTION:
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EFFECTIVE DATE: 1/1/2025	REVISION DATE: 12/3/2025

Purpose:

Relias' Sabbatical Leave is designed to reward long-term employees for their dedicated service to the Company, promote work-life balance, and allow employees to take time for personal growth, rest, and rejuvenation.

Scope:

Relians who meet the eligibility requirements below, regardless of work location.

Policy Statement:

Eligible employees must meet the following criteria:

- Have at least 10 years of continuous employment with Relias* in a full-time position**
- Must be in good standing (not on corrective action of any kind) and meeting all expectations of their role.
- May not have taken any type of leave in the previous 12 months.

* Includes verifiable, continuous time with another Bertelsmann company

** At least 30 hours per week

Amount of Leave:

Eligible employees may take up to 4 weeks (20 business days) of leave. Sabbatical leave must be taken in one continuous period and cannot be split or taken intermittently. Sabbatical is not extended by Company holidays that may occur during the course of the leave.

Pay and Benefits:

- During the leave period, employees will continue to receive their regular base pay.
- Benefits will remain in place for the period of the leave.
- Commission-earning employees are eligible for quota relief for their leave period.

Request Process:

- Employees should discuss with their manager and submit an LOA request form at least 3 months (and up to 6 months) prior to the desired start date of the sabbatical leave. This allows for proper planning and staffing during the leave period.
- All requests are subject to approval by the employee's manager and HR, based on business needs, coordination with other leave types and operational requirements.
- Once a leave is approved, employees will receive a letter from HR confirming the leave dates.

Timing:

- Sabbaticals will typically be granted once every 10 years of employment. An employee who has taken a previous sabbatical will be eligible again at their 20-year anniversary.
- Sabbaticals are encouraged to be taken after reaching the 10-year milestone and may be requested in anticipation of a 10-year anniversary.

Other Details:

- Sabbatical leave is not transferable or redeemable for cash/other benefits if not used.

- Sabbatical leave may not be combined with any other leave type (PTO, Sick PTO, etc.) to extend the length of the leave.
- Sabbatical leaves may not be delayed extensively and must be taken within 3 years of becoming eligible.
- Access to all Relias systems is revoked for the duration of the sabbatical leave to encourage a complete disconnect from work to recharge.
- Those taking a sabbatical leave are still encouraged to take a reasonable amount of flexible PTO, as approved by their manager and aligned with departmental business needs, in the quarters before and after a sabbatical leave and not take sabbatical in lieu of typical PTO.
- If an employee falls ill during a scheduled sabbatical leave to an extent requiring a medical leave of absence, they should reach out to HR immediately. Medical leave/short term disability will take precedent, and the sabbatical may need to be rescheduled/revised. Situations requiring medical leave will be handled on a case-by-case basis.
- Employees are expected to return to work after a sabbatical leave. If a resignation is tendered during a sabbatical, or an employee fails to return to work on the specified date, they may be required to repay a pro-rated amount of the sabbatical leave and/or experience a retroactive cancellation of benefits.
- Sabbaticals may not be used for other employment, and employees are expected to fully disengage from work-related duties during leave. Employees may participate in activities such as mission trips, extended volunteer work setting up a small side business that doesn't violate the CINNAA.
- Employees are expected to follow all applicable company policies during sabbatical leave, including any guidelines regarding use of company property and confidentiality agreements.

Review/Revision History

Date of Change	Completed by	Summary of Change/Review
1/1/2025	Nicole Matteson	Created document

